The New/Old NA Way

Special Edition



Regarding books being thrown away....

"They tried to bury us. They didn't realise we were only seeds"

Volume 59 - July 2025



The New/Old NA WAY Magazine
Volume 59 - July 2025
This magazine was written in open participation by
members of the Groups of The Anonymi Foundation and
members of the Groups who participate in the
Fellowship Service Conference and the
European Felloswhip Service Conference

The New/Old NA Way

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My Gratitude Speaks
When I Care
And When I Share
With Others
The NA Way

The Power of One Meeting

One day I was in a meeting, and a group of addicts showed up with a bunch of Baby Blues. I had never seen them at that time in my life, and I had been in and out of meetings for years. Not only was I very interested in them—they were giving them away for free.

When they said the newcomer is the most important person at any meeting, they meant it.

I slowly started coming around this group of addicts that had shown up to that meeting that night. I watched them, seeing how they truly believed in Narcotics Anonymous—coming together, getting involved with service, giving these books away, expecting absolutely nothing in return. Just carrying a message of hope to the still-suffering addict.

The day I met them, that was me—still using and lost.

Now, today, over three years later, I am clean. I'm becoming that responsible and productive member of society, getting involved with service with the other members of our Home Group, still giving away free literature whenever we can, however we can.

By an anonymous addict in Ohio

The Book that Changed My Recovery

The first time I saw the Gray Book, I was at my wife's ex-grand sponsor's house, and there was a large, spiral-bound book on the coffee table that said "Narcotics Anonymous" on it. As we walked by the table, I said, "What is that?"

"That's my Gray Book," she said.

The book sparked my curiosity. I had been in NA for about two years at that point and had decided to commit myself to the Program, but I had no idea about the history of NA, including the history of the Basic Text. Looking back now, this was a major moment in my life.

The book seemed almost magical, like it was a secret or something. It dawned on me that there was history to be learned. I had heard people say the name of Jimmy K in meetings from time to time and also wondered why there were six editions of the Basic Text. I figured that there had been different editions put out over a long period of time. I learned later that five of those editions happened in six years. That's a lot of editing in a short period of time. I remember at that time developing a thirst—or hunger—for knowledge. I figured, If I'm going to commit my life to this Program, I better know what it's all about.

This was the start of an adventure.

One thing I can say is that my life would never be the same again.

There are some things you can't just unlearn. Narcotics Anonymous existed for about 30 years before the writing of the Basic Text, but the writing process brought about the greatest growth that this Fellowship has ever seen. Before the writing of the Gray Book, there were 600 Groups, and after, there were 1,800. The Fellowship tripled in size in just three years.

The most frustrating thing I hear in opposition to addicts and Groups reading the Gray Book is that it is not "approved literature." I've heard that repeated by so many people who don't even know what they're talking about. It is our responsibility as addicts to understand our history and why we have a Basic Text at all.

The Gray Book is de facto approved because it literally was our first Basic Text. On the cover, it said, "For Review Only, Unpublished Literary Work, Not for Distribution." However, at that time in our Fellowship, Groups were still reading the AA Big Book—which is not our literature.

The Literature Committee sent out 1,800 copies of the Gray Book to every registered Group for review and input, and that became the book a vast majority of the Fellowship decided to read. Because now, we had our own book. This is how NA started to stand on its own two feet as a Fellowship in its own right.

The writing of this book also helped us understand our identity. Before this book, addicts would cross out the word "alcohol" in the AA Big Book and insert their drug of choice. There was an addict who asked the question, "How can we write a book about ourselves if we don't even know who we are?"

This led to the development of our language in NA—of being simply addicts, being clean, and being in recovery—not the language from other fellowships. Many addicts who participated in the writing of the Basic Text continued this movement, promoting our Fellowship, our language, and our message.

The most important thing about all of this is the effect that reading our Gray Book has had on my recovery—and the effect I've seen it have on countless other addicts who have found it, too. I really feel like my recovery started when I found the Gray Book.

There was a fire that developed in me that wasn't there before. I no longer felt like I was sentenced to NA. Now, I received the message and realized that recovery was more than I ever could have thought. I was deeply touched by the stories of the addicts who participated in the writing of the book and what they did in order to be there and to make it happen.

I was touched by seeing that addicts put aside their self-centered nature to be part of something greater than themselves—so that an addict like me could find what they had found. They talked about writing for

addicts who might not even be born yet. Some of them sold cars, motorcycles, and washers and dryers to get to the conferences, where any addict with a day clean could show up and participate in the writing of the book.

The conferences were open-participation and were actively seeking the input of the Fellowship. One addict was even reported to have ridden a bicycle from California to Warren, Ohio, to participate. Addicts even sold their blood in order to come up with funds for the printing of the book.

This was a magical time in NA, and the hard truth I learned was that this Fellowship had fallen a long way from what it was in those days. There was an excitement that was contagious, and I knew that I needed to find that.

I have found that excitement again with addicts when we read the Gray Book together in our meetings and communicating with addicts around the world who feel the same. It seems to speak to us in a way that other books just don't. Sometimes, things will just pop off the page.

Yes, there are grammatical and even a few conceptual errors within its pages—but it was a labor of love, written by addicts for addicts, and it belongs in our meetings. It is our book.

Let's get back to doing the right thing for the right reasons—and think about the addicts who are dying for our message of complete and total abstinence from all mood-changing, mind-altering drugs. A message that is greatly needed these days

Our message of hope—and the promise of freedom from active addiction!

From an anonymous addict in Ohio



What Matters Most

I just want to help drug addicts. So the legal BS and the fake, fellowship-wide group conscience don't matter to me. What's best—that's what matters.

The 12 Steps are a solution for many people, including those with the disease of addiction. I've found that the best presentation for people like us is the Basic Text (before the professional interference) and the Gray Book (the first draft of the Basic Text).

They work together, because so much was left out from the draft to the Basic Text, and even more was added to the Basic Text that wasn't in the draft. Between the two, I find the NA Program—a total recovery program that speaks best to drug addicts.

Now, there are other approaches and literature from NAWS and other fellowships that try to present recovery using the 12 Steps. I just don't see any of them speaking to drug addicts better than what I described above.

So, I try to get Basic Texts and Gray Books into the hands of drug addicts, and I mostly participate in meetings that use them.

Keep it simple.

—Anonymous Addict from Alaska

The Grey Book

This is a short article on the effect and impact of what the so-called Grey Book has had on my personal recovery, and also on the atmosphere and service of the Home Group I belong to.

I stumbled across the Grey Book about eight years ago. I've been involved in an international NA recovery network since early recovery (2016) with a clear focus on NA literature and daily spiritual practice. I've been involved in translation service and international Fellowship Service Conferences since 2017. My recovery is deeply connected to the NA message and how it was carried out in the early days of our Fellowship.

The Grey Book is the foundation of our literature written by addicts for addicts, and is so important to NA, both historically and spiritually.

The book itself is a testament of selfless service and commitment to our way of life. Our early members were literally giving of their own blood to have this book written. It's our most evident example of a service born in and carried out by a Group Conscience guided by a Greater Power. This was truly the voice of both the recovering, and suffering addicts, of that time, and it still speaks to the heart of both newcomers and so called old timers seeking recovery from addiction.

The language in this book is so straightforward, unaltered, and

simple that it's easy to feel that it is written from a place of experience, but also a deep love and commitment to our primary purpose.

The Home Group I belong to, Äntligen Fria Gruppen Sweden, is currently translating the Grey Book into Swedish. As it is a historical document that needs to be kept authentic we call it a translation/interpretation of the Grey Book. We have had several newcomers joining us in this service and they're always amazed by the spirit, the simplicity and directness of the book. We have great conversations about the history of NA as we translate and dig deep into the literature. It has done wonders for our atmosphere, our personal recovery and for our understanding of the origins of NA.

I close with this. Our program and state of recovery is best exemplified in how we live, not in what we read. I'm not looking to convert people to read a certain book, I'm just hoping that we can be open minded enough to let NA be as free as it was intended to be.

Love you / Grateful anonymous member from Sweden.

Finding Connection Through the Gray Book

My name is …, and I am 32 years old. I've been an addict for most of my life. I started using very young. I was first introduced to Narcotics Anonymous at about 15 years old. I was court-ordered to go. I mostly listened and didn't share. I didn't think I had a problem—although now I know my problem started way before then.

I continued to use and cheated my drug tests while on probation. Once I was off, I went back into complete addiction. Even though I spent almost three years listening to people share at meetings and hearing most of the Basic Text readings, it never stuck.

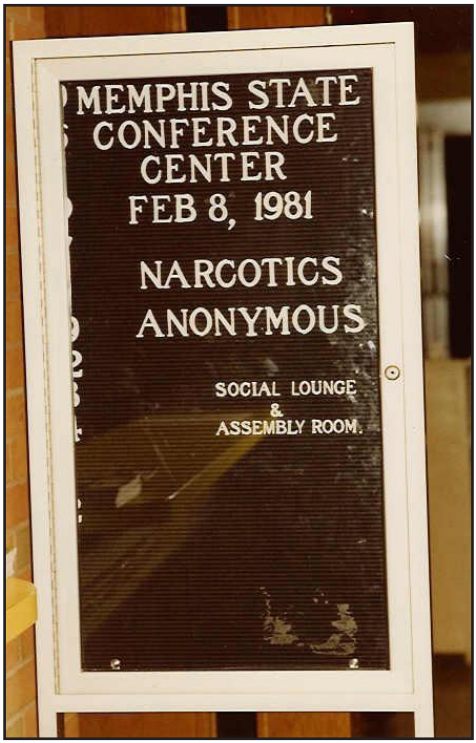
I ended up in trouble again and went to rehab in 2015. The behavior modification rehab program I attended was extremely strict and hard. They made me take a true look at myself, and this is when I realized I had a serious problem. H&I came in and did meetings, and this time I listened—and sometimes even shared.

I chose to go to a recovery house after rehab because I really wanted to stay clean. I went to meetings, but still, it just didn't click. I rarely shared because I felt judged—and I was judged—and sometimes even made fun of. I never got a sponsor because I couldn't find someone I felt I could trust with the secrets of things I did in my addiction.

Ultimately, I quit going to meetings because all the people were cliqued up, and I felt like an outsider. I stayed clean for a little over two years. Then, in 2017, I began a downward spiral that wouldn't let up until 2023 and finally ended in 2024.

I was in and out of institutions and only went to NA while inside, because I knew it would look good on me. I know that sounds horrible, but this is my truth. Still, while in those rooms, I felt judged and didn't share. I always relapsed when I got out. I would stay clean for a little while, but it never lasted.

In February 2024, I got a DUI, and they sent me to rehab again because I was already on probation. This time, I listened to what was said. I tried to share and get involved with NA. A few weeks after getting home, I relapsed again, and back in jail, I sat and cried. I promised myself I would really try this time.



So, I dove into Narcotics Anonymous. When I was released, I went to lots of meetings. I felt judged at the in-person meetings in my hometown, so I chose to go to online meetings. I got a sponsor, and this time I really tried.

The first time I shared at a meeting, while having a burning desire, someone cut me off after two minutes—and that shut me down. I didn't give up, though. I stayed clean "no matter what" because I remembered hearing that in a meeting.

I heard about "90 meetings in 90 days," so I figured I would try it because it was suggested so often. While doing these meetings, I kept feeling shut down. Sometimes, when I shared, I would get muted or even kicked out of the room for swearing or saying something people didn't approve of.

Then I came across the Grateful Wakeup Group, and the first time I was there, I noticed something different. These people were so welcoming and nonjudgmental. They let me share without interruption or negative crosstalk.

I noticed something different about the readings too. I actually understood them. I felt like another addict who had made it through the storm of addiction was speaking directly to me.

I got my Gray Book in the mail and began reading it. I read it in the meetings and at home alone. I was actually starting to understand the

message that had been spoken to me before—but this time, it was spoken from an addict's perspective. I felt like another addict was speaking to me through the Gray Book.

When I went to traditional NA meetings, I felt like a professional or psychiatrist was speaking. So back then, I didn't hear the message. The blue book confused me with big words I didn't understand, and in early addiction, I would rather go use than look up words I didn't know.

The Gray Book, on the other hand—I could understand. And I knew I needed to be a part of it.

I became a Home Group member and got involved in service. The message was so much clearer to me now. The opposite of addiction is connection, and at the Gray Book meetings, I was getting more and more connected. These rooms were always welcoming, and I never felt too ashamed to share. I met people who actually cared.

I always felt so alone, and I know now that's why I continued to use, no matter how hard I tried. I have a sponsor now who is working with me on the steps. The Gray Book way is really working for me—and I wish more people knew about it.

Every chance I get to tell another addict about the Gray Book, I take it—because I feel this book saved my life.

After so many years in and out of the rooms of Narcotics Anonymous, and not being able to stay clean, I really thought I would use for the rest of my life. I think I even said it a few times. But by the grace of God, I was introduced to the Gray Book and finally grasped the things I needed to do to stay clean.

I've got lots of people in my support group, and I know I can always find a Gray Book meeting if I need to share or feel like using and can't get a hold of anybody.

I don't think I mentioned that I did read the Basic Text from front to back during a 9-month jail stay. I even read all the stories in the back. I was clean when I read it, and at the time, I thought if I read it front to back, I would understand and stay clean. But nothing sunk in—because I didn't fully understand it.

When I began reading the Gray Book, after just a few chapters, I realized this was going to save my life. I knew this was the way I would stay clean.

I am so grateful for my Home Group and this book—because without them, who knows where I'd be. I've met some great people so far, and they've all been more welcoming than some of the people I met in traditional NA meetings.

I know the blue Basic Text works for some people. But for those who don't connect with it, I really feel they should give the Gray Book a shot.

After all, the opposite of addiction is connection—and I believe I truly started connecting again when I started going to Gray Book meetings.

Thanks for letting me share my experience. I hope this helps you see how important this book really is.

By an anonymous addict in Florida

The Gray Book and the Freedom I Forgot

For starters I should share what some might call "qualifiers" for this brief piece. I first experienced the fellowship in November of 1978. I was all of 14 years old & I certainly did not have an honest desire to stop using nor was the grey book out in any of its forms. I did however get an unrevised white book and hear the old preambles read from it. I am currently 60 yrs old with almost 13 yrs clean. At one point I had 24 yrs clean and made it back from a relapse that almost killed me when coming back to the fellowship.

I reference all this to kind of give you an idea of what it was like for me to happen on a historical meeting (2021 on Zoom) and hear once again pieces of the original, unrevised preambles. Things like "Addictive personality", The comparison between addiction and "tuberculous or diabetes" it sent goosebumps running throughout my whole human frame.

See I came and went quite a bit during the 1980's and I remember the preambles getting revised and never really agreed with any of the changes. As fond of all that as I was, experiencing being in a home group that regularly studies the grey has impacted my life & recovery in ways that I think I will always struggle to put into words.

I am a bit of a nut & a stickler for detail (like many of us) so the first thing I had to do within my own recovery was to commit not only to a Home Group but also to studying the grey for a year. I figured that would be plenty fair. I know it's a J.F.T. program but my life is at stake, and it seemed like a sort of gamble especially with where my life was at the time. I have to say after 4 years of involvement & service within a historical literature study the "gamble" has paid off in ways that are so spiritual I hesitate to put the experience into words.

I love our grey basic text better than any basic text I have ever encountered. I love it for grammar & spelling errors reminding me that none of us are perfect, for the skipping of titling the 11th step, for the really long examination of step 12 (18 pages may seem like a bit much but as I am fond of saying "one is too many and 1000 is a damn good start") I love the historical index stuff in the back for personal reasons. My first sponsor was at Ash house in Wichita Ks when the first conference/literature convention (I never remember which it was called) was organized. Many days studying the grey I am reminded of things we used to do over 35 yrs

ago. We had the preamble for We Do Recover memorized and said it in unison. Yes, there was a time when we did not have placards to read our preambles from & read from our little white book. Things we used to say like “WE HAVE THE BIGGEST FIRST STEP” “THE WAR IS OVER, THE LIE IS DEAD, WE DO RECOVER” & many other slogan-like sayings.

I also think that one of the biggest ways that the grey has impacted my life is that it’s free and our message should not have to cost an addict anything. I have 30 in my home now and will continue to supply them to anyone who wants them. Surprisingly no one has tried to stop me yet. I am grateful that the group here in Lawrence has allowed me to store a pile there to give away when I go to their meetings.

I have to add here that the impact of the grey on me also has to do with the group I joined in 2021 doing the original writing process & working on a daily reflection from the grey once a week. These days (7/2025) when I am in conversations with addicts in other parts of our fellowship and I mention anything about writing our own literature at group level they look at me like there is an extra head growing out of my neck.

I suppose after doing a quick read through here, that if I had to boil it down to one word or phrase (besides nostalgia) that really shows the impact of the grey on me it would be freedom. Freedom in ways I was not experiencing it for many decades within my recovery. Freedom from self-made prisons I did not know I was trapped in. Freedom’s I was



unaware that I had lost in our fellowship at Group level. The freedom that comes with true autonomy. The grey has a depth and volume, a "urban gritty" feel to the way it reads.

For this addict it's like the difference between listening to a MP3 or CD track played on a decent stereo and listening to a good vinyl record played on a decent system on house speakers. I suppose there are 2 generations that probably do not know the difference because they have not had that kind of experience.

The grey will continue to be my favorite but I certainly love some second edition line by line studies.

Thank U for the opportunity to share & be of service.

By an anonymous addict in Kansas

Finding My Way with the Gray Book

The Grey book of Narcotics Anonymous readings, principles, Steps, and honest sharing served as both a mirror and a compass for me. Before discovering NA, and our grey book. I was navigating a path characterized by darkness, destruction, shame, and spiritual emptiness. I was unaware of how lost I was until I was provided with the tools to gain clarity. It offered guidance. It demonstrated that recovery is not about achieving perfection; rather, it is about progress and accountability. It provided a means to assess my growth, not in comparison to others, but in relation to my former self. Through the sponsorship and our 12 Steps, I acquired the ability to conduct an honest inventory of my actions and motivations. That inventory, coupled with the willingness to share it with another, empowered me to change. Even on days when I felt like I was faltering, our book and fellowship reminded me that effort matters and that honesty, open-mindedness, and willingness are considered passing grades in this journey of recovery. Most significantly, the Grey book assisted me in recognizing that my path did not have to culminate in jails, institutions, or death. I had the opportunity to rewrite my story. And I have. Just for today.

By an anonymous addict in Michigan

My Recovery with the Gray Book

I found the Gray Book 4 years ago. I have been clean for 2 1⁄2 years. I relate to the first edition more than any other book. We read it and the Baby Blue at every meeting and I think this has been the change in my journey for recovery. I started trying to get sober in 2016 and the addition to my recovery from before, is the Gray Book.

I couldn't figure out how to surren-

der to a Higher Power before I found the Gray Book. I now have a working relationship with my HP and pray. I am an atheist and I can believe that there is some power out there bigger than I am.

The book is written in a way I can understand and relate to. It's more raw and it helped me get to my surrender. I feel like I'm doing my 12th step and my 5th tradition by handing the Gray Book out for free to anyone who wants one, because it changed my life.

Please give it a chance and read it.

By an anonymous addict in Texas



Listen to your heart.

(This article was written in the format of open participation of members of the NA Home Group "Osnova" and not only…)

Many of us do not like to believe blindly, although sometimes we find it very convenient. Like addicts, we do not trust words, we are full of skepticism and mistrust, years of use have made us like this. In order to believe, we must first see for ourselves and try. Now, WE KNOW, our Faith is not blind. Some of us believe that the Gray Book itself found them, as crazy as it sounds, and that our Message itself finds those who need it and strive for it. We are grateful to this Power for bringing us here. That is why we are here today, that is why we were fortunate to join NA twice. The first time as newcomers, and the second time when we were introduced to the Gray Book. We agree that this book, for some reason, has tremendous value for recovery. Perhaps because the people who wrote it put the utmost love and care into their work. Or perhaps because they were guided by a Higher Power.

Most of us believe that NA literature is what is written by NA members in a loving, caring spirit and in the spirit of the 12 Steps and 12 Traditions of NA. That is the Gray Book for us. We also believe in our unity, not our uniformity. This book is a gift of love to us, and for many it is a favor-

ite book about recovery. When asked what the Gray Book is, we explain thatThis is the very first version of our Basic Text. It is a Book of incredible power, just read it.Usually, that's enough. We also explain that it doesn't replace our Basic Text and other literature, but rather complements it. Some of us believe that the Gray Book "speaks" to us. Quite often, one of us either reads in it what we were thinking about only yesterday, or finds answers to the questions it asks us at NA meetings. And it's impossible to explain - it can only be felt once, and once felt, you can't trade it for anything else. One of our friends often says, "If I hadn't started reading the Gray Book, I might not have lived to read the Basic Text. But I'm alive, and therefore it works. I'm learning to be grateful. I'm learning to be human."

Some of us said:

"My doubts led me to the dictionary and as I learned the true meanings of words and began to translate the original literature, many questions arose. Many things were radically different from what I sometimes heard at meetings. After some meetings, even more doubts arose and there was less or no identification. I felt like an outcast and thought that perhaps I was somehow different and that I was wrong. I asked for this Power that I had heard so often about, for the willingness to continue recovery, although I had little faith that it could somehow help. Strangely, this led me to the Gray Book, to a completely different history of NA. And I actually felt the identification that is written about in our literature. I call it "a pure, undiluted high." As an addict, I know what a good high is. What I have acquired so far is much better, much better. "You'll learn to think for yourself", I've heard Jimmy K say that.

Trust and verify. This is my experience so far."

Dima, the NA member

"I discovered the Gray Book in early 2020 and read it over the course of a couple of months. The spirit of the book struck me: I felt like I was in a good meeting in the late 1970s. With all the errors and typos, it was a sense of "we get you" from the first page. On some pages, especially the 12th step chapter, it was an uplifting and very spiritual message. I was changed. I felt the spirit I needed to strengthen my recovery. Since then, I have read the book almost every day. I know that I can open it to any page and almost always find an answer to my current situation. There is something special about it, I don't know how to put it into words. I use it to lead others through the 12 steps and see lives changed."

Leo,the NA member

"I came to NA as a living dead man: outwardly I was there, but inwardly I was not - like a rotten tooth

or like a ruined house, the façade of which was decorated with a special screen. I would very much like to say that I was lucky, but now I understand - it is not luck - it is a Miracle! A miracle of God's providence of my Higher Power. At the meeting I was given the Gray Book. Since then I have remained clean for a longer time in my life than I could ever have imagined. But it is not even about cleanliness as such - I simply really found a new path in life and I no longer have the need to use."

Lebed(Swan), grateful addict. (NA Group "Grey Book Chat")

"Studying the Gray Book, as well as getting to know the history of our Fellowship, gives me the opportunity to "hear" its founders, to know and understand their ideas and principles, to feel the true Spirit of NA without the influence of outside opinions, someone's additions or attempts to influence my understanding. I find myself thinking that I want to be like these people who founded and preserved our Fellowship."

Nastya, addict.

"When I came to Narcotics Anonymous, I was completely broken. I had no energy or desire to live, just a sense of emptiness and the feeling that everything was over. I didn't believe in anything, not even in this program or myself. I didn't know where else to turn. A lot of things seemed strange, old-fashioned, and even naive. But the more I read, the more I felt like these words were specifically addressed to me. People who had gone through this themselves. And for the first time in my life, I really felt that someone understands me."

Dima, addict

In loving service,

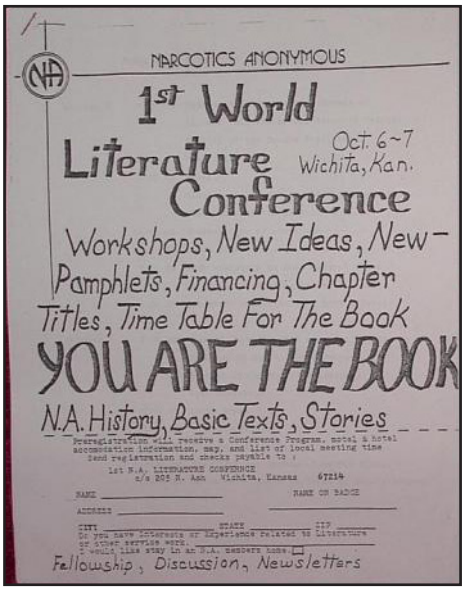
Grateful addicts of the NA Home Group "Osnova", Russia

At a Crossroads Once Again

I'm an addict who's been clean since June 4th, 2004. Around 10 years ago I was at a crossroads with NA once again. There have been many crossroads in recovery but this one almost had me leaving NA completely. I was not getting fed in my local area, region, etc. Instead my recovery was stagnant and something had to convince me that NA truly is for me. Thankfully I found addicts who shared the real history of NA. I found addicts that believed in NA as it was intended. A program of Total Abstinence from all mind altering, mood changing drugs. One that can deal with every manifestation of our disease. I was given a Gray Book and told to read it. The rest of this article will be only regarding that.

At first when reading the Gray Book

I noticed there were lots of errors. My perfectionism and wanting to control and change everything started going crazy. Surrendering that and finding out what the Gray Book really is helped me with that. I learned the Gray Book is the rough draft of our Basic Text. I learned how it was the product of 3 literature conferences: Wichita Kansas, Lincoln Nebraska and Memphis Tennessee. I also learned there were 4 literature conferences after that which helped create our approval form which was to be our first Basic Text. I learned the process of literature with the open participation literature process before it was changed. There is much more history I learned that could fill pages of writing but hopefully if anyone wants to discuss those things they can find me as I would love to talk about it.


NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS

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I would like stay in an N.A. members home ☐

Fellowship, Discussion, Newsletters

The first place in the book I went to was the writing about becoming willing to do what we didn't want to do in order to recover. This sentence from a 6th edition Basic Text was one that the foundation of my recovery had been based on. I was happy to read it hadn't changed much from the original writing but what I read actually I liked more. It simplified things. It took recovery back to its roots. No more was I concerned with the legalities and trying to change all the corrections. I was willing to change my views. We had started a literature study meeting comparing editions of the Basic Text at Home Group. It was great hearing addicts' excitement as they read the Gray Book. Addicts loved its simplicity and said it spoke to them in ways other literature didn't.

Our HG eventually started reading the GB at meetings. We have been doing it for over 5 years now. Probably closer to 7 to 8 years. We have had so many addicts come in and share how they had no idea about the GB and loved reading it. We have given away many Gray Books over the years with money provided by addicts that believe in the Gray Book and how it can transform addicts lives. I remember one time reading it at a function and hearing addicts talking trash behind my back while I was reading it by fire by myself. I wanted to leave and run but there was a Greater Power that day that told me I was going to stay there and face the issues rather than running.

I fought with that GP all night as I wanted nothing to do with facing my fears. I had over 10 years clean and still didn't really know how to face many of my fears. Long story short the GB has had a part in changing that.

I am very grateful for the Gray Book and the addicts that wrote it. Without it I would not have the love for NA and its roots that I do today. I would have left NA probably and thrown my life away. So much more can be written but the phrase at the bottom of the FSC flyer really sums up many things. Today I know that "adversity doesn't build character, it reveals it." So thank you to the Nebraska Region for giving me a reason to reveal my character. Attacks regarding the GB will not be accepted. This book has started a revolution and it is time we learn our history.

By an anonymous addict in Nebraska

There Is No Debate

First, I want to make it clear there is no debate regarding the different service structures because.... WE ARE NOT IN COMPETITION...Service bodies are to be services created by the Groups of NA to carry out services that Groups can't do on their own. The rest of this article may make it appear this isn't true, but it really is about changes that some believe have happened in NA that go against the very foundations of Narcotics Anonymous. NA was founded as a program of Total Abstinence from ALL mind altering, mood changing drugs. One of our foundations is Autonomy of Groups, Creative Freedom, and Group Conscience. We as a Fellowship made many mistakes as we grew, but we as a Fellowship can learn from those mistakes also, so we don't have to repeat them. Unfortunately, it appears as if there are two NA's today.

When it comes to what NA was meant to be, where do you find the basis of NA. A program that addicts can learn, a program where addicts can grow? When addicts are not dictated to or have morals enforced on them by others but are encouraged to think for themselves amazing things happen. Addicts that were not able to get clean, get clean. Totally free from ALL mind altering, mood changing drugs. Addicts that were told they would have to use drugs their whole life to deal with their disease of addiction. Facts are not run from, and fear is learned to be faced rather than run from or covered up with a different form of addiction.

Where do we find Creative Freedom? Where are addicts encouraged to write? Where words can not be used as weapons. Where can we help others learn our language rather than forcing it down their throats? Where can an addict believe that both ideas deserve to be in our liter-

ature? Such as being fully recovered and not limiting God's power and always recovering because we are never cured. How about striving for perfection and the saying adequacy rather than perfection are both in the same book.

Addicts are control freaks, or should I say most addicts. I have yet to meet one that isn't, but who knows. Over time the freedom of something beautiful can be manipulated into something it was never meant to be. We were never meant to have any big shots. We are meant to have only Anonymous addicts. Addicts that every single one of us is precious. We may not always agree with each other, but that doesn't make it ok to belittle or tell addicts they aren't NA members when they may be the only addict in the room that meets the only requirement to be a NA member.

There is no debate for me where I find what NA was and is meant to be. Where it truly is about freedom. Freedom from active addiction in all its manifestations. Freedom from self. I pray every addict reading this has found a place where they feel this freedom. Where they feel a part of and are not separated from by special interest meetings, etc. Where women's input is important for men to hear and where men's input is important for women to hear. Where your sexual identity doesn't matter. Where whatever service body you choose to or choose not to be a part of doesn't matter. Where every addict is supported to find true freedom from ALL mind altering, mood changing drugs. Where services are not about money, property and prestige the very things our Traditions warn us about.

We have addicts keeping alive the spirit of NA that had one of our founders giving away literature despite having to do it from their own social security check. Where addicts believe in something so much they will give their blood and motorcycles to support addicts finding recovery. My question to you is are you one of these addicts that believe in NA as it was intended or is your allegiance to a structure?

By an anonymous addict in Nebraska

I Love the by Addict Writing for Today. WE DO RECOVER!!!!

I am a firm believer that we become recovered from the disease of addiction. I do not believe saying we will always be recovering is good for us . Because we get well in Narcotics Anonymous. That is my experience. One of our founding members till the day he died believed we became recovered.

Once we stop using drugs, lose the desire to use and find a new way to live we have recovered. Yes we continue to work on our spiritual

growth but that is part of our human condition and one reason I take the Steps daily (not work them). What gives a newcomer more hope? hearing you're sick for life or that we get recovered?

WE DO RECOVER is a whole chapter written and its header was written by that aforementioned member. I feel it is much more hopeful for a new person walking in the rooms to hear that they can become recovered. It is my experience. I personally see it as our jobs as members to help addicts access our messages of hope and understand the difference between recovered and cured. They are two completely separate things.

Saying we will always be recovering (still sick) goes against our core message. We have a symbol that is topped by the word freedom.

People like to say recovered = cured. Obviously they've never opened a dictionary as the two have nothing to do with each other.

Today I am recovered

Today I still have the disease of addiction

Today the disease has been arrested.

Today the symptoms of the disease are NOT controlling my life. I am recovered from a seemingly hopeless state of mind (obsession), body (compulsion) and spirit (self centredness)

Today I have found a new way to live. I am clean by Grace not by choice and all glory goes to God as we understand Him. In this moment, I am recovered as a result of following what works! In my experience It works if you work it!! It still works if you don't. It just won't work for you. True story

Today I have true freedom !!!!

Yes , yes indeed ! We do recover. Thank you NA

Anonymous addict from NL



Grey Matters

When I found N.A. I was not much of a reader from the start. Close-minded as I was, it was hard for me to let something in through literature. I remember after a couple of weeks clean I started looking for answers for my problems with daily living and above all, I was looking for hope. Hope that I could make it, hope that at one point I could embrace and enjoy life, that I wouldn't have to feel the way I felt anymore. This is how my mind opened up towards the Literature. The first years I stuck with the Basic Text, I didn't like all the additional literature that was on the table, all these different books, where do I start?

After being part of a Home Group for a good amount of time, I started learning more about the Traditions and about our History. A lot of the information came from overseas, since the Dutch fellowship didn't have much experience. Through the contact with members from the US I was introduced to the Grey Book. I remember seeing it for the first time, it was a big US Letter sized book held together by a spiral bind. I liked the looks of it I remember thinking: I want one. So we did. We went to a printshop and printed some copies of the original scan from the Grey Book also known as the 1981 Memphis Tennessee form.

I loved opening the book from the very beginning and just read random pages or paragraphs. It's like there was always something in there that I had to read. The book spoke to me, and it still does. I read it every day for quite some years now. The way it is written feels more raw and uncut to me, although some of the language comes from a different period in time, I can feel the meaning of the text. Imagine I wasn't even born when the book was written. When asking myself: What is so special about this book compared to others? I started to learn more about the history of the book and the way it was written.

The writing of the Grey Book has been a key moment of growth in our fellowship and I feel blessed to have first hand information from people that were actually involved back then. The therapeutic value of one addict helping another is without parallel, and is demonstrated in this book. It is written by addicts, for addicts. That's it! No interference from professionals. And yes the grammar isn't perfect, and there are some misspellings here and there, but this text speaks to me. That's all that matters.

This book is part of our history and I understand some of the things in there are not our language anymore, or things have been revised in later editions of the Basic Text. What should never be revised or changed is the philosophy that's in this book. I believe it's a God-given program and addicts are used as an instrument to make this a Greater Reality. This is what worked back then for 1000's

of addicts around the world, and all the people that gave their time and energy to make this message available. These principles still work today because they are not bound to time and space. I am deeply grateful for this and pray that many more will be introduced to this book so it will fuel their recoveries and more addicts will be touched because of it.

In loving service,

An Anonymous Addict from the Netherlands.



Grey Book Gratitude

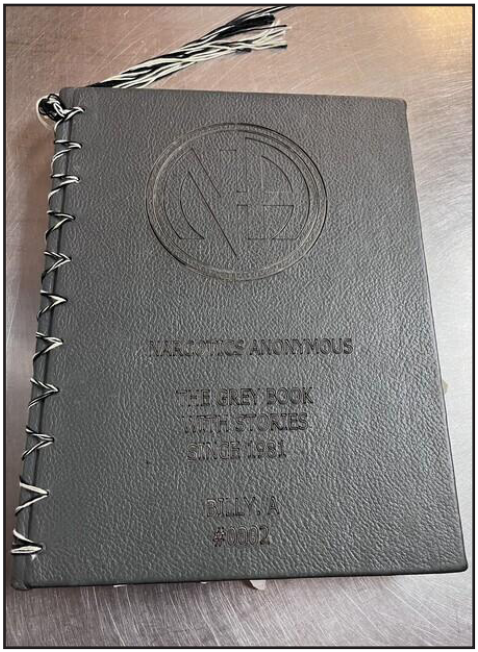
The Greybook to me means Unity, Clarity, Recovery, Understanding and Connection

Before I was introduced to the Greybook I never found any type of literature or text that I could truly relate to or feel connected to on a deep level as I do now with this book. All the things I read about mental health and addiction always made me feel doubt deep down inside, never quite sure about if what I was reading was about me. When I got this book I felt like it was written for me and about me.

When I first got to read some pages in the Grey my mind was blown with the connection I felt to these texts. I was not alone anymore. People went through the same things as I went through and the things I still go through at times. The people involved with writing the book wrote it down so beautifully I was brought to tears and still get brought to tears on the regular. At first I decided I would finish reading this book so I read everything at least once, it was a great way to commit myself to something early recovery and to be honest I finished reading this in just a few weeks, but my experience is that this book can never be finished reading. The way I read it now is I just open the book and read whatever page it opens on and somehow its always relevant and always helpful.

I found it to be, never a bad idea to read a bit in the grey as it always brings about a sense of calmness and realness in my recovery. This is really real. Recovery is real. Life is real. And most of all its worth living. Life is not oblivion anymore. Life is not pain anymore. Not death not destruction. Just simple everyday awareness and calmness that I have always craved. The grey has been a fundamental part of my recovery and still is. It is still unfathomable to me sometimes how a simple little greybook could have impacted my life in the way that it has. Today I am a grateful, elated and relieved addict. Thanks to the grey and NA.

Anonymous Addict from the Netherlands



How the Grey Book grabs me in my life

In 2020, I entered Narcotics Anonymous in the Netherlands. All my life I have struggled to learn the English/American language.

When I entered my first meeting in 2020, I was given that meeting a phone list and the Greybook for free. I didn't know what to do with it because I only knew the Dutch language.

Yet something caused me to delve into it, and started reading, word by word and sentence by sentence, I started translating it through my phone. Just Chapter 1 Who is an addict, Chapter 2 What is the Narcotics Anonymous program and Chapter 3 Where are we here. I started reading things in here that I had so much recognition in, and it started coming to me.

My first reaction to this was really a feeling that is hard to describe. Years of loneliness, isolation and living in fear, I started to feel something here that I hadn't felt before, and that is that there are people who have exactly the same thing as me.

Later at the meeting I also got a free Basic text to take home. At that time there was an unapproved translation of it here in the Netherlands. I started to read further into it, it was the Dutch language that I could understand better.

The Fellowship in the Netherlands organized translation days and translation weekends to translate the Basic text from English into Dutch.



My sponsor took me to such a translation weekend, I had no idea what to do because I did not know the English language.

I just joined in, word by word, sentence by sentence, point by point the whole book was translated. Last year 2024 the "Basic Text Third Edition Revised With Original 4th & 9th Traditions" was translated by addict for addict fellowship approved. A process of 9 to 10 years.

Now here in the Netherlands we also started to translate the Greybook, I really love the Greybook. It contains my way of life, we study the book every Monday at my Homegroup meeting.

We started reading this book 5 years ago at the Homegroup meeting. We read 2 paragraphs about every meeting, and really notice that this is how we really study this book and it also touches many newcomers.

I am looking forward to the next translation weekend of the Greybook here in the Netherlands, they are really powerful weekends, where we are doing the right things. I do not dream often, but my dream is that one day we will have translated the Greybook here in the Netherlands into Dutch, and that it will finally be a translated Fellowship approved book.

I am looking forward to continue translating this great book with the Fellowship here in the Netherlands.

In loving service, from the Netherlands

From Russia

My acquaintance with the Gray Book was a gradual process. At some point, while I was reading our posted literature, I started coming across "daily books" that caught my eye. I began reading two "daily books" every morning, and I started researching what kind of book it was and where I could find it. I remember someone telling me that the Gray Book was not yet available in Russian translation, but that was the path I had to take. Eventually, I came across a group of Gray Book enthusiasts, followed by another group. And then I got this book in my hands, and I finally read it, once, twice, and then again. I don't know, but I'm really inspired by historical literature, the original source, and the slang used in the book. I really like it, and I don't know why, but when I read it, I feel like I'm touching history. It's a really cool feeling, and the Gray Book has brought me a new and unique perspective on recovery. I still read the GBR and I want to squeak, squeal, shout, how simple and clear it is, accessible, a lot of spirituality, a lot about God, and the strangest thing is that I really like it. Well, this is a brief story about the Gray Book, and at the same time, I have learned not to devalue the approved literature, which is also very useful to read, but as I recently heard from a brother, I would call the Gray Book the Bible of Narcotics Anonymous

Thank you
Anton, addict from Russia

The Grey Book

When I first came to NA, I was still in doubt and denial. Literature didn't interest me much yet. I mainly wanted to hear how I could deal with life without using drugs. I went to different meetings and had several books from AA—Twelve Traditions and Twelve Steps, NA Fifth Edition—until I first held the Baby Blue in my hands, which had the original Fourth and Ninth Tradition on it. At the time, I didn't know what that meant, but to me it implied that somewhere the original traditions were missing. Coming from a life full of lies, deceit, and manipulation, I started paying more attention and asking for help from fellows with more experience. That's when I first received the Gray Book. What immediately struck me was that I thought I had to pay for it—I was just clean, so 10 or 20 euros was a lot of money to me. But it was free! I was impressed by the raw language, a book I understood better than any other collection of texts. These days, I try to read a piece every day; sometimes I succeed, sometimes I don't, but what stands out is that no matter how often I read a passage, something always strikes or touches me that helps or confronts me. You could say it's a power greater than myself—and in a way, it is, because the fellows who went before me in 1980 speak exactly the same language as I do. The Gray Book gives me direction, hope, courage, insight, strength, and above all, the tools to deal with life without using drugs.

By an *anonymous* addict in the Netherlands



Another Grey Book Article

The first time I read the Graybook of Narcotics Anonymous, I immediately felt a deep sense of recognition. I didn't understand everything I was reading — — but I could feel it. It touched something inside me that I didn't even fully know was there. Something unknown yet somehow familiar began to stir within me.For the first time, I was able to honestly and wholeheartedly admit that I was an addict. That admission didn't come from fear or desperation, but from something much deeper. It was as if I saw my own thoughts, emotions, and the pain I'd carried with me for so long written down on paper.

I had already read several books about addiction. — but none of them had ever touched me the way this did. The simplicity of the words, the rawness and purity of the text just made complete sense to me. It felt like it came straight from the heart.What still moves me the most is realizing that these texts were written decades ago by addicts just like me, trying to survive. They came together, spent hours writing, struggling, and sharing — not just for their own recovery, but for our recovery. For my recovery. And for the recovery of every addict who has yet to find NA, even those who haven't been born yet.

When I first came to NA, I didn't have money to my name. But that didn't matter. I was given a book, just like every other addict who walks through the doors of NA. That gesture touched me deeply. I had always believed that nothing in life comes for free — that everything had a price, whether in money, debt, or obligation. But at NA, I learned something completely different: that what has been freely given to us, we may also freely give to others.Whether it's literature, time, experience, strength, or hope — it doesn't matter. Everything we have has been given to us by God. And every addict has the right to use it. That principle, that unconditional love, began to change my life.

I pray that many more addicts will find the Graybook. That they may discover the same hope in its pages that I found. That they may come to believe, like I did, that recovery is possible. If it was possible for the addicts who wrote this in the '80s, then it's possible for us, too.The recognition I felt in their words, in their emotions, in how they came to NA — it was too real to ignore. I had to believe in the solution I was reading. And I still believe in it today.

From an anonymous addict in the Netherlands

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Ambt Delden, The Netherlands

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Share... and be shared with..

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THE NEW/OLD NA WAY

"... so that no addict seeking recovery need ever die..."
We publish your input -- the opinions presented are not necessarily those of the New/Old NA Way or Anonymi Foundation